Capacity Building Applicant Guidelines

What This Grant Supports

Capacity building grants help nonprofits strengthen their internal systems, leadership, staff wellbeing, or organizational effectiveness. These grants are designed to help you build long-term strength, not cover general operational costs associated with everyday activities.

Pre-Application Verification

These yes/no questions help reviewers understand your organization's readiness, stability, and ability to carry out the project. They are not used to screen you out. A "no" answer does not prevent you from applying

Question(s)	Guidance
1. Has your board of directors reviewed and approved of this capacity building effort or the decision to pursue funding for it? 2. Does your organization have a current strategic plan, organizational roadmap, or similar guiding document that informs this capacity building effort? 3. Is your organization prepared to dedicate staff time, leadership attention, and internal capacity to support this project over the next year? 4. Is your organization experiencing any leadership transitions at this time? *Transitions do not disqualify you. This helps us understand your context.*	These questions help reviewers understand: • Organizational alignment: Board and leadership support the work • Clear direction: The project fits into a larger plan or need • Readiness: Staff and leaders have time and capacity to do the work • Leadership stability: The organization can carry the project forward

Application Questions

Section	Question(s)	Guidance
Organization Information	Year established Mission, Vision, Values Fiscal Sponsorship Organization Service Area	This section gives reviewers a basic picture of your organization. Reviewers are not scoring you on size or age – they want to understand what drives your organization and who you serve. If you use a fiscal sponsor, confirm your paperwork is complete before applying. To start that process, you may contact grants@cffoxvalley.org.
Request Information	1. Project name 2. Project description 3. Project start date 4. Project focus area	Reviewers are looking for: • The high-level details and summary for your project: What would be your elevator speech to help quickly summarize your proposal? • What capacity you hope to build or improve
Project Summary	1. What organizational challenge, opportunity, or transition is this project responding to? *Why is the right time for additional support?* 2. Who will be involved in leading or implementing this work? *3.* How will this project strengthen your organization's long-term sustainability or effectiveness? *What ongoing strategies or plans will help*	Reviewers will look for: • A clear and compelling organizational challenge, opportunity, or transition that the project directly responds to & evidence that now is the right time for this effort, with appropriate readiness, alignment, or urgency. • Clarity about who will lead or implement the work as capacity-building often requires dedicated time and focus • How the project will strengthen long-term sustainability or

	sustain the benefits of this work beyond the one year grant period? 4. What will be different as a result of the desired additional capacity? *Share how this project connects to your broader vision for organizational growth or stability.* 5. Project Additional Information (optional): Is there anything else we should know about this request?	effectiveness, not just address short-term needs. • What success for this project looks like for the organization: what will be different and/or improved as a result of implementing this capacity building? • Any additional context that helps reviewers understand the organization's capacity-building goals, lived experience, or unique circumstances.
Funding Request and Budget	1. Total project budget 2. Amount Requested *3.* Optional additional amount requested information: *In the event that we cannot fully fund your request, what amount would allow you to meaningfully begin your project? What changes in activities, capacity or outcomes would be affected?* 4. Project Budget Upload & Narrative 5. Current Organizational Budget upload 6. Most recent statement of activities (income statement)	Reviewers will look for: • A clear, realistic project budget that aligns with the scope of work and organizational capacity. • If full funding isn't possible, what amount of funding would help meaningfully start the work? What would the impact of partial funding be on the proposed activities? • A clear, practical description of how grant funds will be used • Ability to understand the current financial health and scope of resources as it relates to ability to implement project.

	7. Most recent statement of financial position (balance sheet) 8. Other uploads as appropriate (Strategic Plan, consultant scope of work)	